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APPROVED LEARNING RESOURCE · SAMPLE

Global Business Communication Guidelines

For employees working with colleagues, managers and customers across countries, languages and time zones.

1. Purpose

These guidelines help employees communicate clearly and confidently in English in an international work environment. They focus on practical habits that reduce misunderstandings, save time and make expectations explicit.

2. Core principles

- **Lead with the key message.** Put the main point, decision or request in the first one or two sentences.
- **Use plain English.** Prefer short sentences. Avoid idioms, slang and internal abbreviations that not everyone knows.
- **Make expectations explicit.** State the owner, the deadline and what "done" looks like.
- **Confirm understanding.** After a meeting, summarize agreements and next steps in writing.
- **Respect time zones.** Write deadlines with a date, a time and a time zone.
- **Offer more than one way to raise concerns.** Not everyone speaks up in a group call. Invite follow-up questions by chat, email or a short 1:1.
- **Raise risks early.** Flagging a possible delay early is expected and appreciated.

3. Communicating a project delay

Use this four-part structure in emails, chat messages and meetings:

Part	What to include
1. What happened	The facts, briefly and without blame.
2. Impact	What changes for the reader: timeline, scope or dependencies.
3. New plan	The revised date and how confident you are in it.
4. What you need	A decision, support or resources, and by when.

Example

> "I want to flag a delay in the customer onboarding project. The integration testing took longer than planned because the test environment was unavailable for three days. As a result, the go-live date will move from 4 November to 11 November (CET). We are confident in the new date. To stay on track, we need approval for two additional testing days by Thursday."

Useful phrases

- "I want to flag an early risk regarding…"
- "Our revised estimate is… and we are fairly confident in it."
- "To stay on track, we need… by…"
- "Could you confirm whether this works for your team?"
- "Just to make sure we're aligned, the next steps are…"

4. Approved learning resources

Resource	Format	Time
Business English Micro-Lessons	Short online modules on the learning portal	10 minutes each
Writing for Global Teams	Two-page quick guide	5 minutes
Peer Practice Circles	Monthly online practice sessions in small groups	30 minutes
Meeting Facilitation Basics	E-learning course	45 minutes

5. Where to verify

- Questions about HR policies: your HR Business Partner.
- Questions about learning resources and enrollment: the Learning & Development team.
- These guidelines support good communication habits. They do not replace official HR policies.

Fictional sample created by PractiAI for an AI learning demonstration. All names, resources and dates are invented.